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Preamble

Python code written in 2023 and translated into english in 2026.

The proposed Jack game is called « Le compte est bon ». It is an adaptation of the maths part involved in the [Countdown TV game](#). The pseudo-random numbers generator is based on an article found on [stackexchange](#) (the seed is an integer < 59 coming from an initial loop when the program waits for the user to press ENTER).

Game starting and rules

To start the game, call VMEulator then *File / Load Program*. Select the *Le_compte_est_bon* folder and clic on *Load Program*. Accept the confirmation message (« *No implementation was found for some functions which are called in the VM code. (...)* »). Select *Animate / No animation* and select preferably fast speed.

The game starts with the message "Hit [ENTER] to begin". This only serves to create a seed for the pseudo-random number generator of the game.

Once ENTER has been pressed, the main game screen is presented :

```
===== LE COMPTE EST BON ! =====
Operations syntax      : P1 OP P2 = RES
P1, P2 : tiles ; RES : result ; OP : + - * /
Example : 3 * 25 = 75
-----
Total score : 0 / Games : 0
-----
Draw   : [983] / Result  [__] / Tiles  [75 10 1 3 9 3 ]
-----
----- Messages -----
Result reached ('Q' to quit) ? █
```

- The first 3 lines below the title shows how each computation should be entered.
 - The total score, followed by the number of games played, is then displayed.
 - The next line shows the target number, the number obtained by the player and the remaining tiles.
- The player must then enter the closest number to the target he thinks he can obtain.
- Then he enters each operation that leads him to the obtained number.
- A game ends when the player reaches the obtained number or when he is out of tiles.

Once a round is finished, the player is awarded (so to speak) a number of points corresponding to the difference between his number and the target number. There is a penalty if he fails to reach his own number. Another round starts automatically until the player hits 'Q' to quit the game.

The goal of the game is, of course, to achieve the lowest possible score.